

Esteban Zúñiga | Senior Manager, NA Professional Services & Operations

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Professional Services Leader | VxWorks Managed Services and Customer Operations for A&D and Industrial Systems

I grew Wind River Costa Rica from 5 to 213 people and now lead a team of 20+ engineers. I started the VxWorks Managed Services program inside Professional Services from scratch and work closely with delivery directors, VPs, product and program managers to support Tier 2 and Tier 3 A&D and Industrial customers at 100% SLA. I am now helping the team get ready for CRA compliance and handling practical security work like CVE remediation and SBOM. Results so far include 25% faster delivery, 98% CSAT and 95% intern to hire.

Impact: 5 to 200+ Team Built | 98% CSAT | 100% SLA Mission-Critical | 95% Hire Conversion (40+) | 25% Faster Delivery | <3% Attrition

Core Competencies: Global Team Leadership | P&L & Budget Management | Professional Services Delivery | Customer Success | SLA/SLO | Cybersecurity & Vulnerability Management (CVE Remediation, SBOM, CRA) | VxWorks / RTOS | Embedded Linux / Yocto | A&D / Industrial Compliance | Salesforce & Jira | SCP Standards | TSIA | OKR / KPI

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Wind River Systems

Sr. Manager Professional Services

San José, CR

Dec 2022 – Present

- Lead a 22-person global team (12 direct, 10 matrix across US, Costa Rica and EMEA) supporting Tier 2 and Tier 3 A&D and Industrial customers. We keep 100% SLA and cut delivery time by 25% with clearer SOWs and shared resourcing for a multi-million dollar North America portfolio.
- Handle security for critical embedded systems day to day. This includes fixing CVEs, building SBOMs and getting ready for CRA, and hardening VxWorks, RTOS and legacy Linux fleets that need to stay up 24x7.
- Look after long term maintenance for RTOS and legacy Linux releases so high availability systems stay ready and can be patched without downtime.
- Built a more scalable delivery model that improved efficiency by 25%, helped grow North America services revenue by 5% and increased billable utilization.
- Work hand in hand with delivery directors, VPs, product and program managers to shape and deliver VxWorks Managed Services and bring CRA compliance into our projects.
- Opened the Professional Services organization in Costa Rica from 0 to 25 engineers and keep attrition under 3% per year since launch through hands on mentoring and clear growth paths.

Wind River Systems

Site Lead & Sr. Manager Operations

San José, CR

Feb 2022 – Nov 2022

- Acted as the local lead for the Customer Experience Organization in Costa Rica, looking after both Customer Support and Professional Services and handling day to day site operations.
- Grew the Costa Rica site from 5 to 213 people in four years across R&D, Support, HR and Professional Services. Set up hiring, onboarding and OKRs. The site now handles about 40% of global support volume.
- Used Salesforce and CRM data to spot at risk accounts and improve retention by 20% for Industrial and A&D customers.
- Created an internship program from scratch that converts 95% of interns to full time hires, bringing in over 40 engineers.
- Since 2017, serve as technical contact for university and industry partnership. Facilitated multiple Wind River software license donations to two local universities and supported joint projects and student mentoring.
- Led local and global innovation groups where peers from different organizations present their work. Created a regular forum to share ideas, get feedback and turn prototypes into improvements.

Wind River Systems

Site Lead & Manager Technical Support

San José, CR

May 2018 – 2021

- Reported to the Global Sr. Director for Customer Support and ran technical support for the North America Linux market.
- Co-led SCP certification for the Support organization from 2019 to 2022 (Service Strategies [servicestrategies.com/service-standards](https://www.servicestrategies.com/service-standards)), harmonizing 12 SOPs across APAC, EMEA and North America to pass the audit and cut handoffs between regions by about 30%.
- Led a team of 10+ engineers supporting global clients on different embedded Linux versions. Kept customer satisfaction at 98%.
- Ran site operations, managed the local budget and built partnerships with CINDE and local universities.
- Represented Customer Success in TSIA benchmarking, using the framework to drive automation and optimization improvements across support and services.
- Partnered directly with Wind River VP to deliver the new Costa Rica office build out. Opened two interim sites to keep operations running, then relocated 200+ people to a larger permanent office on budget and on schedule. Recognized in 2019 by multiple VPs and the CEO for the outcome.
- Found practical ways to lower costs while keeping service steady for our most critical accounts.

Wind River Systems (Intel)

Sr. Embedded Software Engineer

San José, CR

Jan 2017 – May 2018

- Technical lead for Tier 2 global customers on Embedded Linux, Yocto and Wind River Linux.
- Built custom IoT and embedded solutions on Intel, ARM, PowerPC and MIPS for demanding hardware.
- Connected engineering and customer success by keeping technical roadmaps aligned with what customers actually needed.

Intel Corporation

San Jose, Costa Rica

Sr. Mixed-Signal Validation Engineer

Oct 2015 – Jan 2017

- Led ASIC design, mixed signal validation and SoC debugging, pulling together global test strategies to hit hardware deadlines.
- Ran design, testing and debugging for several ASIC projects side by side with design teams to make sure mixed signal SoCs were solid.
- Put in place verification plans and coordinated testing across sites so work stayed on track.

Inband Software S.R.L.

San Jose, Costa Rica

Lead DSP Engineer

Jan 2011 – Oct 2015

- Led a team of 10+ engineers building signal processing algorithms from MATLAB models to efficient C code on DPUs.
- Tuned software for DPUs to get the best performance on customer hardware.
- Improved RTOS networking code to deliver low latency for demanding communication systems.
- Owned the full project lifecycle, from planning and design to handling tough technical escalations.

EDUCATION

Technological Institute of Costa Rica (TEC)

Cartago, Costa Rica

Master's Degree in Digital Signal Processing, Cum Laude (9.2/10)

2015

- Graduated Cum Laude with 9.2 grade. Focused on real-time processing, system optimization, and strategic technology implementation.

Technological Institute of Costa Rica (TEC)

Cartago, Costa Rica

Licentiate Degree in Electronics Engineering

2010

- Specialized in embedded systems and telecommunications, integrating technical engineering with managerial foundations.

Centro Cultural Costarricense Norteamericano (CCCN)

San José, Costa Rica

Speaking+ English Program

2010

- Advanced professional English certification.

SKILLS & EXPERTISE

People Management:

- Global Team Scaling (from 5 to 200+ employees)
- Mentoring and Leadership Development; established high-conversion internship-to-hire programs (95% rate).
- Cross-functional collaboration across R&D, Customer Success, HR, and Professional Services.
- Performance management, capacity planning, and organizational growth strategy.

Project & Ops Management:

- Full software project lifecycle management
- Service delivery optimization (+25% efficiency) and data-driven Customer Success strategies.
- Risk mitigation, technical escalation management, and stakeholder engagement at the C-suite level.

Technical Oversight:

- Strategic maintenance of RTOS (VxWorks) and Legacy Linux versions for high-availability systems.
- Cybersecurity leadership: vulnerability management, security patching (CVE remediation), SBOM and CRA readiness, and security-first architectures.
- Expert knowledge of Yocto Project, Wind River Linux, and mission-critical embedded systems.

Tools & Frameworks:

- Management: Salesforce, Jira, CRM Analytics, SAP, SharePoint, Microsoft Project.
- Programming: C/C++, MATLAB, Python, Assembler (x86, ARM).
- Web Development: Full-stack development including Frontend (HTML, CSS, JavaScript) and Backend (Node.js).
- Automation & Scripting: Advanced automation using Bash and Perl for CI/CD and system optimization.
- Technical Oversight: Git, Docker, CMake, QEMU, GDB, LaTeX, JTAG, SPICE.

LANGUAGES

Spanish: Native proficiency.

English: Full professional proficiency (Fluent).

French: Professional working proficiency (Fluent).

AWARDS

Wind River Shine Award: Two-time recipient of the company's highest honor for leadership and technical innovation.